development agenda resonated strongly with the Rakhine people's desire to see benefits from natural resources and receive local opportunities. This focus was on control of the state development agenda as an alternative policy approach, while its communal approach was as a strong contender for Buddhist nationalist credentials over and above other parties.

The main ANP electoral strategy was to translate Rakhine ethnicity to ethno-nationalist sentiment, and thereby get support for ethno-nationalist development and security policies. As the ANP was identified strongly with an anti-Muslim sentiment, it also received Buddhist-nationalist support. As they went to vote, the people in Rakhine State faced three main electoral choices: inspiration for national change from the NLD; stability and status quo from the USDP, especially in the context of communal segregation; and an advancing ethno-nationalist agenda from the ANP.

DETAILED RESULTS OF THE 2015 ELECTION IN RAKHINE STATE

At the Rakhine State level, the electoral results showed victory for the ANP in terms of seats and popular votes. Compared to the electoral performance of other ethnic parties in their home states, the ANP achieved significantly more in Rakhine State, winning forty-five out of the available sixty-four seats for both houses of national parliament and the State Assembly. The ANP won twelve out of seventeen Pyithu Hluttaw (lower house) seats from Rakhine State, while the NLD gained four, and the USDP one. The ANP also won ten out of twelve seats for the Amyotha Hluttaw (upper house), while the NLD and USDP received only one each. For the State Hluttaw, the ANP won twenty-three out of thirty-four township-based seats. The NLD gained eight seats, and the USDP five. The ANP received seventy per cent of all elected seats from Rakhine State. Full state-wide results for the Pyithu Hluttaw, Amyotha Hluttaw, and State Hluttaw are shown at the end of the chapter.

At the national level, the ANP's electoral representations amounted to only 4.45 per cent in the Amyotha Hluttaw and only 2.7 per cent in the Pyithu Hluttaw. While the ANP received twenty-three seats, or sixty-five per cent, of the elected seats at the state level, this was one seat short of gaining the majority of the Rakhine State Hluttaw, which consists of thirty-five elected and twelve military-appointed members. This means